Internship Program

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Addendum September 2025

A. Retirement Savings Plan (ISP)

i. Contributions & Withdrawals

Q: Will the contributions we have made to the ISP be paid back to us?
A: Yes. Staff may withdraw their ISP contributions (including employer and employee portions) upon contract termination and exiting the Foundation.

Q: When will we receive the payouts after our internship/contract ends?
A: The withdrawal process starts after the last payroll run and can take up to 60 days to complete. This period covers disinvestment of assets and Trustee approval.

Q: Can we leave the contributions as savings for future use?
A: Yes. You may opt to become a deferred member of the plan after leaving the Foundation. Your savings will continue to accrue interest and can be accessed at a later date. The same withdrawal process applies. Please contact the Specialised Services team to initiate the withdrawal when ready.

Q: Under what circumstances can an employee withdraw their retirement contribution?
A: According to policy, withdrawal is allowed:

- Upon retirement or early retirement from the Foundation.
- Upon termination of employment due to:
  - End of contract for Fixed Term Employees (FTE) with no renewal.
  - Exit (resignation, redundancy, or termination).
  - Death while in service at the Foundation.

B. ISP Withdrawal Process

1. Staff notify the Specialised Services team of intent to exit the ISP.

2. Specialised Services completes a Leaver Notice Form and submits it to Alex Forbes.

3. After the final pension contribution is received (last payroll run), Alex Forbes issues leaving service options paperwork directly to the employee. The employee completes it (including bank details).

4. After all documents are submitted and Trustee approval is received, Alex Forbes arranges the disinvestment of funds.

5. Once disinvestment is requested, allow about 10–15 working days for the funds to reach the nominated bank account.

C. HealthCare Benefits

Q: When does medical cover end after leaving the Foundation?
A: Medical cover ends on the last day of employment for the principal member.

Q: Can medical cover be extended beyond the last day of employment?
A: Yes, but only in exceptional circumstances and with approval by the Director, Total Rewards and Mobility. Even then, the cover may only be extended up to the next renewal date of the group medical plan.
Q: Who should we contact with queries about healthcare benefits or offboarding?
A: Please direct all healthcare and offboarding queries to Faith, who will provide guidance and support.

D. Benefits my Way (BMW)

Q: Can I pay for a course now and claim from BMW later?
A: No. BMW does not provide upfront payments. It operates on a pay-and-claim basis, meaning the expense must have been incurred by the employee in the same year of the claim to be reimbursed.